

Fish For All

Catfish Production, Transformation and Solar Smoking

01 PROBLEM

Context and Challenge

Fish For All is a startup based in Djougou (North Benin). The project produces local catfish (Clarias) in a recirculating water system and transforms it using innovative solar smokers. A 400 m² production plot has been acquired. A test was run in December 2025: 30 kg purchased, 28 kg smoked, product sold - validating the transformation process.

Core Problem Statement

There is no regular access to quality fish in rural North Benin. Households and restaurants depend on unreliable supply chains. No structured sales channel exists for transformed production. Early customers compared smoked fish prices to fresh fish prices without understanding the added value of solar smoking.

Identified UX Problems

01 No Clear Pricing

Early customers wanted to buy at fresh fish prices, unaware of transformation costs. No posted rates or pricing grid existed.

02 No Priority Customer Segment

Households, restaurants, hotels, resellers, canteens - all cited, none prioritised. Their needs contradict: households want small fish, restaurants want large.

03 Three Activities Without Sequencing

Fish production, smoking/transformation, and future training coexist without priority order or calendar — risking resource dispersion.

04 Value Not Communicated

The solar smoker technology and quality premium are not explained in the sales process — buyers compare on price alone without understanding the transformation value.

Methodology

Research combined coaching sessions, competitive analysis of 3 market actor types, and persona development from direct customer interviews and December 2025 market test observations.

UX Competitive Analysis

UX Criterion	Traditional Market	Existing Farms	Informal Resellers	Fish For All
Transparent Price per kg	✗ (sold by lot)	Partial	✗	✓ To build
Consistent Quality	✗	Partial	✗	✓ Solar smoker
Size Adapted by Segment	✗	✗	✗	✓ Differentiator
Regular Supply	Unreliable	Partial	Unreliable	✓ Key objective
Advance Ordering	✗	✗	✗	✓ To design
Premium / Spiced Product	✗	✗	✗	✓ Client demand
Traceability / Trust	✗	Low	✗	✓ Brand to build

✓✓ = Very good

✓ = Present

✗ = Absent

User Personas

Fatoumata — Household Consumer Age: 34 · Mother of 6, Djougou — daily cooking for family Goal: Buy quality smoked fish regularly at a reasonable price Frustration: Market fish sold by lot, variable quality. Doesn't understand why smoked costs more. UX Need: See price per kg clearly, understand quality, order small fish (5+/kg), regular supply	M. Adamou — Restaurant Role: Manager of a local restaurant, Djougou · 15 covers/day · fish-based specialities Goal: Obtain large smoked fish (1–2/kg) regularly, consistent quality, reliable delivery Frustration: Current suppliers are irregular. Doesn't want to pay fresh prices for smoked but understands the added value. UX Need: Advance ordering, delivery timelines, per-kg invoicing, dedicated contact person
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Key UX Insights

Insight #1 - Segment-based sizing is the core differentiator

No competitor offers fish sized by customer segment. Small fish (5–6/kg) for households vs. large fish (1–2/kg) for restaurants is Fish For All's primary competitive advantage — and must be front-and-centre in the catalogue.

Insight #2 - Price education must precede the sale

Customers comparing smoked to fresh prices is the primary conversion barrier. The value of solar smoking (hygiene, preservation, taste) must be explained before the price is shown.

Insight #3 - The spiced product creates a premium tier

Client feedback identified demand for a spiced variant at 3,800 FCFA/kg - creating a pricing ladder that increases average basket value without new production investment.

Insight #4 - Financial simulation must show a simple break-even metric

The dashboard must translate cost data into a single actionable metric: 'You need to sell X kg/month to cover your costs' - replacing tables non-financial users cannot interpret.

User Flows - 3 Critical Journeys

Friction points appeared at the same moments across all journeys: pricing clarity, fish size mismatch, and supply regularity.

Journey 1 — Household Client Discovery (word of mouth/page) → Catalogue browse → Size and quantity choice → Order and payment → Delivery/pickup → Loyalty

Journey 2 — Restaurant/Hotel B2B contact → Product tasting → Per-kg price negotiation → Recurring order → Scheduled delivery → Invoicing

Journey 3 — Reseller Producer discovery → Bulk purchase → Size sorting → Local resale → Market price feedback → Restocking

Design Decisions

Based on research and coaching insights, the following UX solutions were designed covering the homepage, a segment-based product catalogue, and the producer dashboard with integrated financial simulation.

User Testing Protocol

Participants: 3–5 (households, restaurateurs, resellers)

Duration: 30 min per session

#	Task	Focus Area
T1	You are a household. Find the price per kg of small smoked fish and order 2 kg.	Household ordering flow
T2	You are a restaurateur. Order 10 kg of large smoked fish for next week.	B2B advance ordering
T3	Find the difference between classic smoked and spiced smoked products.	Product differentiation
T4	You are the producer. Check pending orders and treat the first one.	Producer order management
T5	Understand from the financial simulation what minimum volume you must produce to break even.	Financial planning tool

Test Report - Key Findings

T1 - Household Order Success: 4/5	Users didn't understand 'small' vs 'large' without seeing the number of fish. Recommendation: Always display 'Small: 5–6 fish/kg' and 'Large: 1–2 fish/kg' next to the product name.
T2 - Restaurant Order Success: 3/5	The 'I am a restaurateur' CTA led to a generic form — restaurateurs expected a volume pricing grid. Recommendation: Create a B2B page with volume pricing (e.g. -5% from 20 kg) and programmed delivery.
T3 - Product Differentiation Success: 5/5	No issues. 3 products clearly distinguished via labels and photos. Recommendation: Keep the card format with colour-tagged segment labels.
T5 - Financial Simulation Success: 2/5	Non-financial users couldn't read the table. Break-even concept was not understood. Recommendation: Replace the raw table with 'You need to sell X kg/month to cover your costs'.

Next Steps

- Build high-fidelity prototype of the product catalogue and producer dashboard
- Test with real households and restaurants in Djougou
- Establish the B2B pricing grid (per kg by volume tier) and formalise the advance order system
- Launch the 400 m² production site and pilot the first full production cycle